As for Geelani having more than one place to live, I wish that had been true—it would have saved us all a lot of time looking for a rented place after he was arrested. Even after his acquittal at least thirty-five landlords refused their houses to us on rent. I can only say that the journalist was just trying to mystify Geelani's image and feed the public sensational tidbits.

The *Hindustan Times* of 17 December 2001 carried a four-column story: 'Don lectured on terror in free time'. The story is by Sutirtho Patranobis and has a photo of Geelani with the caption 'The Ideologue', and a picture of Afzal with the caption 'The Mastermind'.

This is a story based on an interview with the principal of Geelani's college, Prof. Riaz Umar. The principal testified that Geelani was a conscientious teacher and that he took his classes regularly. The journalist quotes Prof. Umar:

> He mixed around in the college as any other professor and spent time in the staff room as well. Students liked him and I have also not heard any colleague complain about his behaviour. But he became reserved after a point. There was nothing extraordinary in his character either.[8]

The entire story is a positive image of a good teacher but the headline is taken from the last paragraph and I quote that in its entirety:

> Investigations have revealed that by evening he was at the college, teaching Arabic literature. In his free time, behind closed doors, either at his house or at Shaukat Hussain's, another suspect to be arrested, he took and gave lessons on terrorism. Gilani, Shaukat and Mohammad Afzal, the third person to be arrested, were long-time friends sharing similar views.[9]

The journalist quotes police sources on matters which go against his own investigation. The police were desperately trying to construct an image of the 'ideologue',[10] and the journalists had suspended all their usual disbelief and scepticism and were swallowing the police stories whole.

The same day, the *Hindustan Times* carried a story by Rajnish Sharma entitled 'Hunt for Teacher's Pet in Jubilee Hall':

> Investigations into the international connections of S.A.R. Geelani have led the intelligence agencies to Delhi University's Jubilee Hall hostel in the north campus.
>
> A team of senior intelligence and Delhi police officials today visited Jubilee Hall and some of the STD phone booths around the hostel.
>
> Intelligence sources said Geelani was 'extremely friendly' with a Jordanian student who had been staying at Jubilee Hall,
>
> The agencies are now trying to trace the Jordanian who, after completing his MSc in Physics from Aligarh University, had enrolled for a PhD at Delhi University a few years ago. 'Geelani used to visit the Jordanian student's room No. 164 regularly where the two used to have long